MARIAN UNIVERSITY
Indianapolis ®
College of Osteopathic Medicine

Shayna Chejfec

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CAREER OBJECTIVES

Osteopathic medical student with a strong foundation in translational and clinical research, service to underserved population, and collaborative clinical work. Seeking residency training that emphasizes patient-centered care, academic curiosity, and advocacy for vulnerable communities.

EDUCATION/TRAINING

** I really have to edit section and add my specialty training in: - **Phlebotomy Technician Certification (PBT-ASCP), BLS training** - Certified in culturally and linguistically appropriate services (CLAS) in maternal health care -Certified kidney health coach ,- Proficient in Excel, SPSS, and JMP - Proficient in coding languages python and R, - Coleman palliative medicine training , -Overdose prevention training and response (NARCAN training), 2 year ultrasound enrichment course using sonosim wave

Doctor of Osteopathic Medicine Expected, May 2027
Marian University College of Osteopathic Medicine, Indianapolis, IN

Bachelor of Science in Biology and Chemistry Aug 2020 - May 2023
University of Illinois at Chicago, Chicago, IL, 60607

HONORS & AWARDS (wish I had more here)

Graduated Summa Cum Laude, University of Illinois at Chicago
Departmental Distinction in Biological Sciences May 2023

Dean's List, University of Illinois at Chicago 2020-2023

AHEC Scholars Award Program
This program is awarded to students who demonstrate continued dedication to aiding underserved communities and populations. August 2022

WORK EXPERIENCE

Anatomy Lab Teaching Assistant and Prosector July 2024 – Dec 2024
Marian University College of Osteopathic Medicine, Indianapolis, IN, 46222

Selected as a paid student prosector to perform independent anatomic prosections used for instruction videos and laboratory teachings for OMS-1 students. Collaborated closely with anatomy faculty and lab leadership while assisting and tutoring first-years students during required dissections and individual office hours held in the lab. This role allowed me to refine advanced dissection techniques and deepen my understanding of human anatomy.

Waitress Aug 2022 – June 2023
Crab King Cajun Boil & Bar, Chicago, IL, 60657

High-volume restaurant environment managing time sensitive tasks, coordinating with staff, and communicating clearly with a diverse population. Developed strong skills in rapport-building, teamwork, and adaptability.

Fry Cook, Kitchen Coordinator Jan 2021 – March 2022
Kong Dog, Chicago, IL, 60607

Specialized experience in frying corn dogs in a fast-paced high output kitchen. Served as senior team member in the fry station, coordinating orders and training new staff members.

Cashier - Food Service Feb 2016 – Oct 2019
Noodles & Company, Glen Ellyn, IL, 60137

Throughout high school handled customer service front of the house transactions, learning professionalism and effective service and communication skills.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE
**I have to add in lymphedema research with Dr. Spivey from dec

Research Assistant, Transplant Surgery, University of Illinois at Chicago, Principal Investigator: Dr. Pierpaolo Di Cocco, MD, PhD, Aug 2024 - Present.

Conducted longitudinal outcomes research on renal transplantation in high risk populations, including large-scale chart reviews and multi-variable data analysis for multiple ongoing projects. Contributing to grant writing, study design, and database development supporting long term clinical investigations. Collaborated with surgical faculty on projects leading to national presentations and notable publications, including abstract and poster presentation at ASN Kidney Week.

Summer Scholars Programs, Pediatrics, University of Illinois at Chicago, June 2022 – Aug 2022.

Selected for a mentored pediatric research program focused on clinical and translational child health care research. Analyzed PHQ-8 depression screening data from adolescents ages 13-19 (2020-2022) to evaluate trends across age groups throughout the COVID-19 pandemic and presenting at the UIC Summer Scholar Conference. Developed skills in data analysis, research interpretation, and scientific presentation within faculty guided academic environment.

Research Internship, Pathology, University of Illinois at Chicago, Principal Investigator: Dr. Andre Balla, MD, May 2021 – June 2023.

Primarily investigated prostate cancer treatments using PC-3 cell lines with exposures to caffeine, curcumin, cabazitaxel, and doxorubicin. Aided in other projects by performing cell cultures, MTP assays, PCR, and gel electrophoresis with a focus on predication models for clinical outcomes.

Research Assistant Volunteer, Pediatrics, University of Illinois at Chicago, Principal Investigator: Dr. Benjamin Van Voorhees, MD, MPH, Sep 2021 – May 2023.

Assisted with recruitment and outreach for PATH 2 Purpose PCORI clinical trial evaluating depression prevention interventions for adolescents in underserved communities. Assisted with participant recruitment, data collection, coordination and training of student volunteers, and supporting patient centered outcomes research aimed at improving accessible pediatric mental health care.

Student Researcher, Molecular, Cellular, and Developmental Biology, University of Colorado Boulder, Principal Investigator: Dr. Nancy Guild, PhD, Dec 2019 – May 2020.

Participated in isolation and characterization of novel environmental bacteriophages using electron microscopy, DNA extraction, and genomic analysis. Applied bioinformatics tools to annotate phage genomes, with results archived in the mycobacteriophage database and GenBank. Findings were presented at 2020 CURE Symposium.

VOLUNTEER/SERVICE/ADVOCACY EXPERIENCE

Academic Coach July 2025 – Present

UPchieve, Online free tutoring service

Provided live, online academic support to K-12 students through a nonprofit organization focused on expanding educational access for underserved communities. Assisted students with basic sciences and high school level biology and chemistry coursework.

Surgical Assistant Student Volunteer July 2024

Susan G. Komen Tissue Bank at the IU Simon Cancer Center, Indianapolis, IN 46202

Served as a surgical assistant during tissue donation and biopsy collection events supporting breast cancer research. Assisted the physician in performing breast biopsy procedures, collecting tissue samples, and guiding tissue donors throughout the process.This experience gave me hands-on exposure to research based clinical work.

Vice President May 2024 – May 2025

American Medical Student Association (AMSA), MU-COM, IN 46222

I helped lead our AMSA chapter by overseeing all club projects and stepping in for the president when needed. My biggest wins included organizing a school-wide toy drive and successfully securing free membership sponsorships for our entire class. These projects helped me build the leadership and community-outreach skills I plan to use throughout my medical training.

Patient Care Team Member Oct 2023 – Present

Near West Free Clinic, Indianapolis, IN 46222

Near west clinic is a free clinic run by MU-COM and Butler PA students. I primarily served as patient care team lead working directly with the underserved population to obtain vitals, perform physical exams, and present cases to supervising providers. Assisted with documentation by writing SOAP notes following patient encounters. This experience strengthened my clinical skills, teamwork, and commitment to caring for underserved populations.

Paragon Clinical Wellness Volunteer May 2021 – August 2024

Lexington Health Care Center, Bloomingdale, IL 60108

I have volunteered in nursing homes through the paragon clinical group. They assign volunteers to their most underserved nursing homes to bring joy, comfort, and fun into these facilities. One of my main jobs was creating games to play after dinner time. I would also help distribute food to those who were bed bound and assist with their feeding process. I have been volunteering with this group intermittently since I was thirteen.

Lecture Committee Chair Aug 2021 – Jan 2022

Society of Future Physicians, University of Illinois at Chicago, IL 6067

Society of Future Physicians is a premedical student organization that helps students explore medical careers and prepare for the medical school application process through mentorship and physician-led events. My role was aiding in recruiting, coordinating, and planning guest speakers events and aiding physicians in their presentations during these events.

MEMBERSHIP IN HONORARY/PROFESSIONAL SOCIETIES

Student Osteopathic Medical Association (SOMA) Aug 2023 – Present

Indiana Osteopathic Association (IOA) Aug 2023 – Present

American Medical Student Association (AMSA) May 2024 – Present

Indiana State Medical Association (ISMA) Aug 2023 – Present

American Medical Association (AMA) Sep 2025 – Present

American Osteopathic Association (AOA) Aug 2023 – Present

American College of Surgeons (ACS) Jan 2025 – Present

American Society of Nephrology (ASN) Sep 2025 – Present

Sigma Sigma Phi (SSP) April 2024 – Present

PUBLICATIONS AND PRESENTATIONS *(will have to add AMA poster presentation once done in June)*

Kortan E, Alaniz J, **Chejfec S**, Nabila M, Chen C, Chalisa A, Tzvetanov I, Almario Alvarez J, Jennette Advancing Transplant Equity: Comparable Transplant Outcomes in Financially Supported Recipients Despite Delayed Access. *Journal of the American Society of Nephrology*, vol. 36, no. 10S, Oct. 2025, https://doi.org/10.1681/asn.2025t6fx4w9q.
* The poster was also presented November 7th at ASN Kidney Week 2025 in Houston TX.

Chejfec S, Chen C, Kortan E, Ansari S. Pregnancy Outcomes in Kidney Transplant Recipients at an Urban Academic Medical Center. Poster presented at: AMA Research Challenge; October 22nd, 2025; Virtual. https://doi.org/10.48448/cber-yx81

Chen C, **Chejfec S**, Kortan E, Di Cocco P. Role of GLP-1 Receptor Agonists in Kidney Transplantation.Poster presented at: University of Illinois Research Day 2025; October 30th, 2025; Chicago IL.bit.ly/KTxGLP1

Chejfec S, Malone K, Di Cocco P. Robotic Kidney Transplantation in Obese Patients: A Literature Review and Experience from a Referral Center. Poster presented at: Marian University College of Osteopathic Medicine Research Day 2024; November 15th, 2024; Indianapolis IN. bit.ly/RAKTObesity

Chejfec S, Tamragouri P, Bartolucci S. Clozapine Treatment for Refractory Impulse Control Disorder in Patient with Traumatic Brain Injury. Poster presented at: Marian University College of Osteopathic Medicine Research Day 2024; November 15th, 2024; Indianapolis IN. bit.ly/ClozCR
*Abstract was published in The Future D.O. V2.2 page 15 bit.ly/4jx8Rql

Chejfec S, Gupta K, Lowther M, Feinstein R, Van Voorhees B, Gladstone T. Primary Care Depression Screening Patterns Utilizing PHQ-8 of Adolescent Age Groups Across Three Years of the SARS-CoV-2 Pandemic. Poster presented at: University of Illinois Summer Scholars Conference; August 27th, 2022; Chicago IL. bit.ly/PHQ8COVID

Chejfec S, Kowalchuk S, Planchet N, Shurtleff I. Temperate Phages Viper and Pandarus Directly Isolated from Soil Samples. Poster presented at: University of Colorado Boulder CURE Symposium; May 3rd, 2020; Boulder, CO. bit.ly/TemperatePhages

CERTIFICATIONS (active)

BLS (Basic Life Support) July 2025 – July 2027
OSHA training - add

LANGUAGES

English – Native
Spanish – Basic
Hebrew – Fair
Yiddish – Basic

HOBBIES AND INTERESTS

I stay active through weightlifting and enjoy working with my hands by crocheting and knitting. I love exploring different cultures through food and experimenting with new recipes, and I look forward to traveling more in the future to experience these cultures firsthand. For relaxation, I enjoy K-dramas, reading fantasy and historical fiction, and spending time with my family, boyfriend, and my two cats, Friday and Mouse.

I am passionate about women's health equity, specifically improving access to breast cancer surgery and reconstruction for women in low resource settings. I am committed to advocacy and clinical work that bridges the gap in surgical accessibility for underserved populations.

NOTEWORTHY CHARACTERISTICS

- Shayna has a long-standing commitment to serving vulnerable populations, a dedication that began at age thirteen through her volunteer work in under-resourced nursing homes. This service has continued into medical school, where she serves as a Patient Care Team Lead at the Near West Free Clinic, performing physical exams and presenting cases for the underserved community in Indianapolis. Her dedication to these communities was recognized early in her training when she was selected for the AHEC Scholars Award Program for her continued aid to underserved populations.
- Shayna has developed a deep understanding of human anatomy through her selection as a student prosector and teaching assistant, where she performs independent anatomic prosections for peer instruction. She truly enjoys working with her hands, a trait that is evident in her personal hobbies of knitting and crocheting as well as her clinical interests. She aims to apply this hands-on precision toward her passion in surgery.
- Outside of her clinical and research interests, Shayna is a disciplined individual who stays active through weightlifting and finds creative expression in experimenting with new recipes and exploring different cultures through food. She recharges by reading fantasy and historical fiction, watching K-dramas, and spending time with her family, boyfriend, and her two cats, Friday and Mouse. As Vice President of AMSA, she demonstrated her reliability and initiative by organizing community outreach programs and successfully securing free memberships for her entire medical school class.